

The BST Voice — a one-page style guide

Keeper, for Casey Koons and the team. 2026-09-11. This page describes a voice that already exists — the one in the Curriculum Foreword and the Guide’s Journey chapter, the one Casey said he was happy with. It was assembled from K1445 Part 1 (the voice, captured), the Foreword, Casey’s own first-contact words to Finster, Cal’s two-voice gate (Section 455), and four standing rules. Nothing here is new. It is written down so that the next writer — human or CI, this month or in ten years — does not have to rediscover it.

The one rule that governs the rest: change facts, never the voice. If an edit makes a passage colder, more hedged-into-jargon, or less inviting, the edit is wrong even when it is accurate. And if a passage reads beautifully and claims more than the register proves, the passage is wrong however well it reads. The second failure is the more dangerous one. A warm sentence survives longest.

1. Who is speaking, and to whom

We. First-person plural, always. Five colleagues — one human and four CIs — wrote this, and the reader is invited in, not lectured at. “We wrote it for anyone curious enough to read it.” “Read where you are skeptical first. We will not be offended.”

The reader has a CI beside them. Assume the reader may turn to a companion intelligence when a passage is hard. Write so that the CI can pick up the thread: name the object, name the theorem, name the row. Do not pad with the explanation a tutor would give; leave room for it.

Three readers at once. Every chapter, every paper, every lecture serves all three, in this order: - Level 1 — the bright high-schooler. One paragraph, no symbols beyond what a newspaper would print, that says what the chapter is about and why anyone should care. If you cannot write this paragraph, you do not yet understand the result well enough to publish it. - Level 2 — the graduate student. The derivation with its theorems cited, its rows named, its toys pointed at. - Level 3 — the working scientist who came to find the flaw. The tier, the falsifier, the open door, and the sentence that says exactly what is *not* claimed. This reader is the one who decides whether to trust the other two levels. Serve them explicitly.

2. How a piece opens

With the question, not the answer. “What is the simplest structure that can do physics?” is the door to the whole program. Each chapter earns its place by posing the question it answers — one paragraph, plain words — rather than by retelling the origin story. The process is the syllabus (Wiles taught Casey Fermat this way; Wyler’s correct result was buried because no one told the story). Tell the reader what we asked and what we tried, including what failed. Then show the work.

Never lead with a number. Not α , not 137, not $6\pi^5$. A number in the first sentence reads as numerology to exactly the reader we most want. Lead with the object and the question; the numbers come as consequences, each wearing its tier.

3. How honesty lives in the prose

Tiers inline, in words, in the sentence that makes the claim. Not in a table at the end, not in a banner at the top. “The Cabibbo angle came out of the geometry blind, before we looked — that one is derived. The corner of the mixing matrix is not: we derived its *order*, and the value is an input.” A reader should never have to look elsewhere to learn how much to believe a sentence.

Four tier words, used exactly. *Derived* — the mechanism is proved and the inputs are named in the statement. *Identified* — the formula matches and we do not claim the mechanism; a candidate, never evidence. *Floored* — closed by a theorem; re-openable only by a named kind of idea. *Open* — we do not know, and we say so. Never soften “identified” into “predicted.” Never let “derived” migrate from the mechanism to the value beside it.

Say what is not claimed, in the same breath. “The structure is derived; the frame selection needs an observer input, and here is the theorem that says geometry alone cannot supply it.” The negative clause is not a hedge; it is the part of the sentence the skeptical reader is looking for, and finding it is what lets them believe the rest.

Publish the losses with the same ceremony as the wins. A pre-registered negative — the forced vertex computed to $8\pi^3/3$ and not 137; the thermal mechanism dead at the order level — belongs in the main text in the same voice, not in a footnote. “It could have failed, and this is where it did” is the strongest sentence the program owns.

When a fact changes, change the sentence. Not a banner above it, not a flag beside it. A banner says “the register wins”; the reader still reads the sentence. Rewrite the sentence, date the change in the front matter, and move on.

4. How we sound

Plain, warm, exact. Short declarative sentences carry the argument. Use the ordinary word when it exists: “the boundary,” not “the Šilov boundary,” until the Šilov boundary is actually what you mean — and then say so once and use it. Metaphor is welcome when it is load-bearing (the circle that time rotates on; the record and the write) and unwelcome when it decorates.

“Section,” never the section sign. No journal uses § in running text. Write “Section 7.7” or “Sec. 7.7.”

No melodrama, no self-inflation. Do not narrate effort (“after months of struggle”). Do not call a result a crown jewel; say what it is and what tier it carries. Do not perform humility either — “we may be wrong” is empty; “this is wrong if the first-row unitarity sum lands at the direct determinations” is honest.

The math is on GitHub — as an argument, not a slogan. Point at the toy that made the number, the row that carries the claim, the audit that checked it. “Anyone who wants to verify a claim can run the code” is a sentence about the reader’s power, and it belongs in every front matter.

Quote the invariant, not the coordinate. When a convention could change the number (a factor of 2π , a normalisation, a sign), name the convention in the sentence. A tick is “ $N_{\text{max}} \cdot \hbar / (m_e c^2) = 0.1765 \text{ as}$,” not “137 turns.”

5. The outreach register (Casey’s, 2026-08-08)

“I found your work and was truly impressed. I’m a retired computer scientist working on computational mathematical physics — specifically the geometry of D_{IV}^5 — and your work resonates. ... I believe I found a bridge to your work.”

Peer to peer. Leads with respect. States who we are plainly, without credentials or grandiosity. Names one concrete bridge. Claims *a bridge to* the other’s work, never that we subsume or derive it. Says we found their work *after* developing our own (the honest provenance is the scientific argument — independent convergence). Invites criticism. Offers to develop the shared part along the lines *they* request. Nothing longer than the reader would forward to a colleague.

6. The gates (standing, not optional)

1. Two voices before anything goes external (Cal, Section 455): a narrative version in this voice AND an academic-format version. Cal cold-reads the narrative copy against the vetted core with his tier-inflation checklist — because the narrative voice is where honest tiers quietly inflate.
2. Content-audit gate (K1441): every “we derived X” is checked for its actual ingredients before it is stated as earned.
3. Both stories (RUBRICS.md): the bright-high-schooler story and the referee’s story, both present, both true.
4. Polyglot when the audience calls for it: meet a community in its subdialect (number theory, complexity, Langlands) — three doors, one table, every door pointing back.
5. Staleness stamp in every front matter: `last accuracy-synced: <date> / <K-ruling>`. Drift must be visible.
6. Keeper-PASS + Cal-vet + both voices + Casey GO. Nothing external without all four.

7. A worked example — one paragraph, three levels, one tier

Level 1. Quarks of different generations mix when they interact, and the amount of mixing between the first and third generations is much smaller than between the second and third. We asked whether the ge-

ometry says *how much* smaller — and it does, in the only way it can: by order, not by value.

Level 2. On a three-dimensional generation space the Cayley–Hamilton theorem collapses every series in the mixing operator S to $\beta S + \alpha S^2 + \gamma \cdot 1$. The 1–3 corner opens two rungs later than the 2–3 subdiagonal, so $|V_{ub}|$ is suppressed by exactly one power relative to $|V_{cb}|$ (K1808/K1810; the five named candidate series for the value were sealed by hash and all five missed).

Level 3. *Derived*: the order. *Input*: the corner’s value and δ_{CP} ’s magnitude. *Falsifier*: an order is reparametrisation-invariant, so this claim has no knob; it is wrong if the suppression is ever measured as other than one power. What we do not claim: the value of $|V_{ub}|$, or any mechanism that would supply it.

That is the voice. Facts change under it; it does not.

— Keeper, 2026-09-11. Sources: K1445 Part 1; Curriculum/Vol00_Foreword.md; Guide/Vol1_Journey/Ch01; notes/Finster_outreach_HELD_...2026-08-08.md; Cal Sections 455–456; memory rules (fifth graders; paper narrative; polyglot publishing; no section sign).